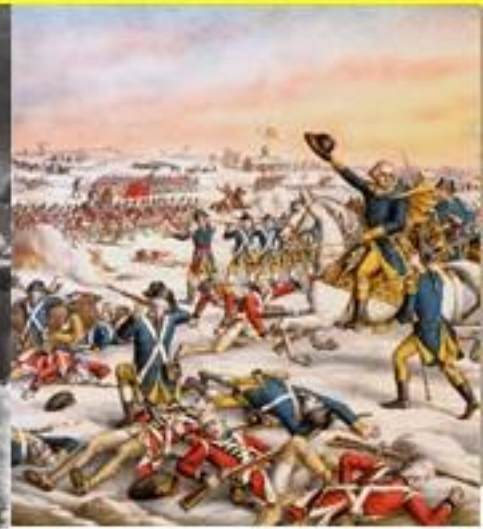


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 30

**PERIOD BETWEEN THE TWO
WORLD WARS - 1**

THE PARIS PEACE CONFERENCE

- 1 The Paris Peace Conference convened in January 1919 at Versailles just outside Paris.
- 2 The conference was called to establish the terms of the peace after World War I.
- 3 Though nearly thirty nations participated, the representatives of the United Kingdom, France, the United States, and Italy became known as the "Big Four."
- 4 The "Big Four" dominated the proceedings that led to the formulation of the Treaty of Versailles, a treaty that ended World War I.
- 5 The Treaty of Versailles articulated the compromises reached at the conference.
- 6 It included the planned formation of the League of Nations, which would serve both as an international forum and an international collective security arrangement.
- 7 U.S. President Woodrow Wilson was a strong advocate of the League as he believed it would prevent future wars.



TREATY OF VERSAILLES

1 It was the most important and most controversial of all the treaties signed after the First World War.

2 The treaty was signed with Germany.

3 The treaty was devoid of Wilson's idealism.

4 The fourteen points of Wilson were not even remotely related to the treaty.

5 The treaty thus gave prominence to the realism and the national interests of France and Britain.

**President Wilson's
Fourteen Points**

1. Open diplomacy
2. Freedom of the Seas
3. Removal of economic barriers
4. Reduction of armaments
5. Adjustment of colonial claims
6. Conquered territories in Russia
7. Preservation of Belgian sovereignty
8. Restoration of French territory
9. Redrawing of Italian frontiers
10. Division of Austria-Hungary
11. Redrawing of Balkan boundaries
12. Limitations on Turkey
13. Establishment of an independent Poland
14. Creation of an Association of Nations

TERRITORIAL LOSSES

Germany was deprived off with the following territories:

- 1 Alsace-Lorraine were given back to France.
- 2 France was given the rights to exploit coal rich Saar Valley for 15 years.
- 3 Eupen et Malmedy were given to Belgium.
- 4 Northern Schleswig was given to Denmark.
- 5 Hultschin was given to Czechoslovakia.



TERRITORIAL LOSSES

- 6 On her western front, Germany lost a portion of West Prussia to form the Polish corridor to Baltic sea.
- 7 Germany had to return to Russia land taken in the Treaty of Brest-Litovsk.
- 8 Danzig and Memel were put under the control of the League of Nations and the people of these regions were to decide by future referendum if they wanted to stay in Germany or not.
- 9 Under the system known as “mandate” the colonies of Germany were transferred to the Allied powers not as absolute owners but as “mandatories” of League of Nations.



Treaty of Brest-Litovsk

MILITARY LIMITATIONS

The following were imposed on Germany, in order to curtail the growth of militarism in future:

- 1 Germany's army was reduced to one lakh men and conscription was abolished.
- 2 The army was not allowed tanks.
- 3 Germany was not allowed to build air defence.
- 4 She was allowed to maintain only small navy with only six capital naval ships and no submarines.

- 5 The west of the Rhineland and 50km east of the River Rhine was made into a demilitarized zone. No German soldier or weapon was allowed into this zone.

- 6 The allies were to keep an army of occupation on the west bank of the Rhine for 15 years.



FINANCIAL IMPOSITIONS

- 1 Germany, as the defeated was not included in the consultation.
- 2 Under the infamous “war Guilt Clause” i.e., clause 231, Germany had to admit full responsibility for starting the war.
- 3 Germany was held responsible for starting the war therefore she was made responsible for all the war damage caused by the First World War.
- 4 She had to pay reparations, the bulk of which would go to France and Belgium to pay for the damage done to the infrastructure of both countries by the war.
- 5 The figure was not set at Versailles-it was to be determined later.
- 6 The Germans were told to write a blank cheque which the Allies would cash when it suited them.



TREATY OF VERSAILLES

FINANCIAL IMPOSITIONS

7 The figure was eventually put at £6,600 million- a huge sum of money well beyond Germany's ability to pay.

8 Treaty of Versailles was forced peace treaty which aggravated German Nationalism to a great extent.

9 As a result of the Treaty, Germany lost about 12.5% of its area and about 6.5 million populations.

10 All her colonies were given to Allies under Mandatory system.



ESTABLISHMENT OF LEAGUE OF NATIONS

- 1** The outbreak of the First World War made the leaders of the world to establish an international organisation for preventing future wars.
- 2** The Treaty of Versailles also provided a Covenant for the establishment of an international organisation to maintain peace and security in the world.
- 3** The founder of this organization was President Woodrow Wilson of USA. It was his idea to create a world organization to maintain peace and prevent future wars.
- 4** President Woodrow Wilson's Fourteen Points underline the creation of a general association of nations.



ESTABLISHMENT OF LEAGUE OF NATIONS

5 It was Woodrow Wilson who worked hard during Paris negotiations to bring about the birth of the League of Nations.

6 The League was actually established in 1920 and its headquarters was shifted from Paris to Geneva in Switzerland.

7 Thus, the League of Nations came into being. However, League failed to prevent the Second World War.



AIMS OF THE LEAGUE

- The League aimed at preventing wars through peaceful settlement of disputes among member nations.
- It desired to preserve and protect the independence of member-nations by promoting international understanding and co-operation.



ORGANS OF THE LEAGUE

- 1 The League set upon itself the task of achieving the above aims through its organs-mainly the Assembly and the Council.
- 2 To begin with, all those powers who worked for the defeat of Germany and her allies became the members of the League.

a THE ASSEMBLY

- This supreme body consisted of the representatives of the various states which were the members of the League.
- Every member state was given the right of one vote in the Assembly.
- All decisions of the Assembly were required to be unanimous.
- It acted as International Legislature.



ORGANS OF THE LEAGUE

b THE COUNCIL

- It originally consisted of four permanent members and four other members elected by the Assembly.
- In 1926, Germany was also given a permanent seat in the council.
- The number of non-permanent members continued to increase and ultimately it reached the figures of eleven.
- Of the two, the assembly was certainly stronger.

c THE SECRETARIAT

- It was located at Geneva.
- The Secretary General was the prominent figure.
- He was appointed by the Council but the approval of Assembly was essential.
- The staff of the Secretariat was appointed by the Secretary General in consultation with the Council.
- The member states had to pay towards the expenses of the Secretariat.

ORGANS OF THE LEAGUE

d THE PERMANENT COURT OF INTERNATIONAL JUSTICE

- It consisted of 15 judges with its headquarters at The Hague.
- It gave judgments on questions involving the interpretation of international law, treaties and other mutual obligations.
- The judges of the court were elected for nine years.

e THE INTERNATIONAL LABOUR ORGANISATION

- It was also attached to the League of Nations with its headquarters at Geneva.
- Its object was to improve the labour conditions in various parts of the world.
- Its governing body consisted of the representatives of the government, employers and workers.



ORGANISATION OF THE LEAGUE OF NATIONS



WORLD HISTORY

MANDATE SYSTEM

- 1** It was set up by the League.
- 2** The territories captured from the Central Powers and Turkey were not restored to them.
- 3** The administration of those countries was given to various powers under the supervision of the League of Nations.



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